

HOW - WHAT

PRIMARY HOW · SECONDARY WHAT · TERTIARY WHY

How the HOW-WHAT communicates

How your wiring shows up in writing and speech, how each orientation hears it, and the three adjustments that buy the most understanding.

HOW YOU NATURALLY WRITE

You write like an operator's manual with a pulse: complete, ordered, and pointed at how work actually gets done. Process, structure, and efficiency are your native subjects, and you flag what breaks before it breaks. What thins out is the story: vision language, the reframe, the line that tells the reader why the system deserves to exist. You document the machine beautifully and leave the meaning as an exercise.

Your signature

PRESENT

- + Numbered sequence, dependencies, criteria
- + Process vocabulary: "streamline", "handoff", "bottleneck"
- + The pre-emptive flag: where it breaks, and the fix
- + Concrete next steps built into the structure

CONSPICUOUSLY ABSENT

- Vision and possibility language
- The reframing question
- The audience's so-what
- Appetite for ambiguity of any kind

HOW YOU LAND

HOW readers	Hear a native speaker. Your documentation becomes the team's reference.
WHAT readers	Move easily on your structure; they may trim your completeness to hit a date, and you will feel it.
WHY readers	See a machine without a mission. Process detail with no frame reads as bureaucracy, even when it is the thing quietly saving everyone's week.

THE BLIND SPOT

The system you improved will be resourced by people who never read past the first paragraph. If that paragraph is process, the work reads as overhead. If it is impact, "this cuts onboarding from three weeks to one", the same document funds itself. The meaning is not decoration, it is the budget line.

For WHY readers

Lead with the impact claim. One sentence of changed outcome before any process, pulled from the purpose brief, never improvised on the spot.

For WHAT readers

Surface the first step. Your structure is complete; bold the single next action so momentum wiring can grab it without reading the manual.

Everywhere

Ration the completeness. Full detail one layer down, always available, never mandatory. The appendix is your friend; the wall of text is not.